

VRF#26-09-MTNJR: Google AI Studio / Interactions API

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Vulnerability Report

Reported by Bitu79 [György Istókovics] on 2026-09-14, 18:36 (1 hour, 12 minutes ago) via web submission.

ID: VRF#26-09-MTNJR

Have you attempted to contact the vendor? Yes

Date of First Contact 2026-02-02

Summary of Previous Communications

The vendor officially closed my report as "Won't Fix - Intended Behavior", refusing to delete data from their servers. The security defect is a Placebo Deletion / Broken Access Control in Google AI Studio: when a user deletes a chat and empties the Drive Trash, the backend servers retain 100% of the conversation context. Restoring the deleted .json file via Drive File Recovery instantly reloads the active chat directly from the server. When I proved this on their forum, they banned my accounts and deleted my posts. Their DPO only sent an automated boilerplate response.

Affected Vendor Google LLC

Affected Product Google AI Studio / Interactions API

Affected Version	unknown
Significant ICS/OT impact?	False
Related to AI/ML systems?	True
Reporter Name	György Istókovics
Reporter Email	istokovicsgyorgy79@gmail.com
Do you want to be acknowledged by name in any published document about this vulnerability?	YES
Do you want us to share your contact information with vendors?	YES

Description

Google AI Studio fails to execute server-side prompt deletion when a user deletes a chat session. The deletion button only hides the chat from the user interface.

When you use Google's official Drive File Recovery tool to restore the deleted JSON pointer file from the Trash bin, all the supposedly deleted prompts and the entire chat history instantly reload directly from Google's backend servers. This architecture directly and severely violates the Right to Erasure (GDPR Article 17 - Right to be Forgotten).

Exploit

There is no external attacker. The vulnerability and the violation are committed directly by the Data Controller (Google) against the end-user. The only condition is the user relying on the "Delete" button, while Google illegally retains private prompts on their backend servers after the erasure request. This is a systemic GDPR non-compliance fraud.

Impact

There is no external attacker. The direct impact is that the end-user completely loses their Right to Erasure (GDPR Article 17), because Google illegally retains and stores the private prompts and chat data on their backend servers after a formal deletion request.

Discovery

The vulnerability was discovered through manual testing. After clicking "Delete" in Google AI Studio, I accessed the unique session link of the deleted chat directly. The entire chat history and all prompts instantly reloaded from Google's backend servers, proving the data was never destroyed.

Is there evidence that this vulnerability is being actively exploited?

YES

Exploit References

Yes. Google is actively exploiting this setup as an intentional business practice. Their security team officially closed my multiple tickets regarding this defect and stamped them as "Won't Fix - Intended Behavior". This is irrefutable proof that they are consciously and actively keeping user prompts on their servers after deletion requests.

Is the vulnerability publicly known?

NO

Do you plan to publicly disclose this vulnerability yourself?

YES

Disclosure Plans

I have already started public disclosure. The forensic reports, server logs, and evidence of the vendor's bad-faith censorship are permanently published in public GitHub repositories and independent web archives to ensure data transparency.

Comments

The vendor has actively censored this case on their platform to hide the data retention issue. Please investigate the server-side behavior during chat deletion, as they refuse to fix it.

Files

[+ Add File](#)



[vrf26-09-MTNJR_9e9f2137-44a7-40cd-85cc-a9f38e039505.pdf \(/vince/comm/vrf/attachments/7820/\)](#)

Uploaded by Bitu79 on 2026-09-14

Activity

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Bitu79 commented on report

Technical Clarification: Stateful vs. Stateless Chat Architectures

To ensure the vulnerability is assessed correctly, the distinction between the two chat modes in Google AI Studio must be established, as the vendor conflates them to bypass liability:

1. Temporary Chat (Stateless):

Architecture: Operates via the GenerateContent API (as configured in the logs).

Data Lifecycle: Stateless. The conversation state is maintained client-side only during the active session. No persistent backend interaction_id state is stored, and there is no associated file in Google Drive.

Deletion: Deletion is effectively permanent because the state is inherently ephemeral.

2. Saved Chat (Stateful):

Architecture: Operates via the Interactions API. This is explicitly documented by Google as providing "server-side state management" and "stateful features."

Data Lifecycle: Stateful. Every prompt is tied to a persistent interaction_id on Google's backend storage. The client-side .json file in Google Drive is not the data itself, but a persistent anchor/pointer that grants the client access to the stateful backend session.

The Vulnerability: When a user triggers "Delete" for a Saved Chat, the UI only orphans the local JSON pointer. It fails to trigger a backend DROP or DELETE signal to the Interactions API storage. Because the backend state is not purged, any restoration of the client-side pointer instantly resumes the live, unpurged backend session, bypassing the documented 1-day TTL purge.

Conclusion:

The vendor is committing "Placebo Deletion" by conflating these two modes. They claim the system is "stateless" (referencing mode #1) while knowingly and actively maintaining persistent, stateful backend storage for mode #2 (Saved Chats) without executing deletion requests. This is a critical desynchronization between user-facing deletion commands and backend data processing.

<https://ibb.co/Q3p5pGZh> (<https://ibb.co/Q3p5pGZh>)

2026-09-14 (now)

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Bitu79 commented on report

Google's official, public documentation (the developer specification) explicitly states that data is automatically purged according to TTL (Time-To-Live) rules (e.g., after 24 hours), but in reality, it persists indefinitely in the background on active servers—this is not an intended feature, but a critical software vulnerability and architectural deception!

The IssueTracker bot that responded with "Won't Fix – Intended Behavior" is a programmed falsehood designed to brush off researchers. When official documentation contradicts backend behavior, that constitutes a severe Specification-Implementation Desynchronization in cybersecurity.

CERT engineers must see this IMMEDIATELY, as it proves that Google's system operates defectively and dangerously when measured against its own specifications!

<https://ai.google.dev/gemini-api/docs/logs-policy> (<https://ai.google.dev/gemini-api/docs/logs-policy>)

<https://ai.google.dev/gemini-api/docs/zdr> (<https://ai.google.dev/gemini-api/docs/zdr>)

[https://ai.google.dev/gemini-api/docs/troubleshooting...](https://ai.google.dev/gemini-api/docs/troubleshooting) (<https://ai.google.dev/gemini-api/docs/troubleshooting>)

[https://github.com/istokovicsgyorgy79-jpg/CanusLu...](https://github.com/istokovicsgyorgy79-jpg/CanusLupus/blob/main/552682596%20Issue%20Tracker.PDF) (<https://github.com/istokovicsgyorgy79-jpg/CanusLupus/blob/main/552682596%20Issue%20Tracker.PDF>)

[https://github.com/istokovicsgyorgy79-jpg/CanusLu...](https://github.com/istokovicsgyorgy79-jpg/CanusLupus/blob/main/557281747%20%20Issue%20Tracker.pdf) (<https://github.com/istokovicsgyorgy79-jpg/CanusLupus/blob/main/557281747%20%20Issue%20Tracker.pdf>)

2026-09-14 (24 minutes ago)

B

Bitu79 submitted vulnerability reporting form

2026-09-14 (an hour ago)

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